



GRADUATE DIPLOMA IN MANAGEMENT

September 2025

GDM 601 – Leadership and Management in a Digital Economy

(Batch 86)

Case Study (Pre-seen)

Qualification	ATHE Level 6 Graduate Diploma in Management
Issued Date	4 September 2025
Module Tutor	Sasari Ranasinghe <i>BSc</i>
Exam Date & Time	13 September 2025 – 2.00pm – 5.10pm

Learning Outcomes:

By the end of this unit students will be able to:

- LO1:** Understand the approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives
- LO2:** Apply theories of management and leadership to support teams in achieving goals

DOUG MCMILLON: STRATEGIC INNOVATION IN DIGITAL AGE TRANSFORMATION

Doug McMillon has been the CEO of Walmart Inc. since 2014, leading the company through significant changes to modernize the organization for future success. He consistently emphasizes the agile nature of the retail industry and underscores the importance of leaders being at the forefront introducing new ideas and driving transformation.

The specialty of McMillon is that he held numerous jobs at Walmart Inc., and he got ranked up due to his leadership abilities and steadfast dedication. McMillon is a strategic risk-taker who makes significant investments in new industries beyond retail, such as healthcare and financial services. By using these diversification strategies, Walmart gets the opportunity to initiate new offerings and enter new markets. McMillon's focus is on leveraging technology to drive innovation, and one example is the opening of five automated distribution centers for fresh food delivery across the country. This allows McMillon to attain his vision of broadening the company's role in customers' lives. Under his leadership, Walmart has thrived as a global retailer, serving millions of communities throughout the world.

Doug McMillon refers to his employees as "associates" and values their creativity, emphasizing that Walmart's success lies in the hands of its people who are willing to take risks and implement new ideas. In 2021, he decided to raise Walmart's minimum wage to \$15 per hour, following the trend set by industry competitors such as Amazon and Target. This move demonstrated his commitment to improving employees' livelihoods, even while facing pressures to maintain shareholder returns and manage operational costs. This instance highlights his prioritization of employee well-being.

Under his leadership, Walmart has invested heavily in training and development, including more than \$2.4 billion in Walmart Academy over the last five years. He has also championed wage increases for associates, reflecting his commitment to creating a supportive work environment and improving employee well-being. Guided by core values of integrity, innovation, and customer-centricity, McMillon ensures that Walmart not only maintains its position as an industry leader but also contributes positively to society and the environment. His leadership style reflects a deep understanding of the retail industry and a strong dedication to Walmart's mission.

LEARNING OUTCOMES AND ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Learning Outcomes	Pass	Merit	Distinction
1. Understand the approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives	1.1 Discuss different approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives	1M1 Analyse different leadership and management performance and competences to meet organisation objectives	1D1 Recommend suitable leadership and management approaches in different organisational context to meet organisation objectives and achieve goals
2. Apply theories of management and leadership to support teams in achieving goals	2.1 Apply a range of management and leadership theories to creating teams for given organisation contexts	2M1 Compare the impact of different theories of management and leadership, and their impact in given organisation contexts	

~ End of Paper ~

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